

# THE DAILY BRIEF

JULY 25, 2026

## AI & TECH

*The week's most important developments in artificial intelligence and technology*

**OpenAI's New AI Keypad Is a Coder's Playground — and Everyone Else's Mystery.** OpenAI quietly rolled out what it's calling an "AI keypad," a physical input device that lets users interact with language models through a dedicated hardware interface. Early testers say it's genuinely useful for coding tasks — autocomplete on steroids, basically — but for the average person it reads like a solution in search of a problem. The device ships with a companion app that learns your workflow over time. Whether it becomes the next mouse or the next Google Glass depends entirely on whether OpenAI can convince non-technical users they need it. (TechCrunch)

**Reid Hoffman and Mark Pincus Are Betting \$100 Million That AI's Next Big Thing Isn't Coding.** A new AI lab called Prentis is raising a nine-figure round with a contrarian thesis: automating routine computer tasks — scheduling, filing, form-filling, the digital grunt work of daily life — will eventually be more valuable than writing code. Hoffman and Pincus co-founded the lab, and the bet reflects a broader industry pivot from "AI that builds" to "AI that does." If it sounds like an agentic computing vision, that's because it is. The question is whether the market is ready to pay subscriptions for a digital secretary that actually works. (TechCrunch)

**Cognition Adds Personality to Devin by Acquiring Poke.** AI coding agent Devin just got more human — or at least more personality. Cognition, the startup behind Devin, acquired Poke, a company known for building distinctive conversational interaction models. The deal signals something important: in the race to build useful AI agents, raw capability isn't everything. How an AI communicates — its tone, its style, whether it feels pleasant to work with — is becoming a genuine competitive differentiator. Coding agents are multiplying fast; the ones that feel least like robots may win the most users. (TechCrunch)

**Anthropic's Opus 5 Says Efficiency > raw Power.** Anthropic released details about Opus 5 this week, and the headline isn't a benchmark leap — it's a philosophy. The model is designed around token efficiency: getting the same or better results while spending fewer tokens per task. This reflects a maturing phase in AI development where raw capability gains are flattening and the economics of inference are coming into focus. Cheap, fast, and good enough is winning over expensive, brilliant, and slow. Enterprise buyers are paying attention — token costs compound at scale. (Ars Technica)

**A Canadian Legislator Accidentally Read an LLM Response Into the Parliamentary Record.** In a moment that will appear in AI history books, a Canadian MP was caught reading what appeared to be an AI-generated rewrite of their own speech on the floor of the legislature. When colleagues called it out, the MP acknowledged the text was "a more natural, flowing version" generated by a large language model. The incident is being treated as a cautionary tale, but it also reveals how deeply LLM text has permeated ordinary professional workflows — and how difficult it is becoming to distinguish machine-generated prose from human writing. (Ars Technica)

**SpaceX Lost Another Booster on Friday, But the V3 Starlink Constellation Keeps Growing.** SpaceX launched another batch of V3 Starlink satellites on Friday, adding to its ever-expanding broadband constellation. The booster that delivered them didn't make it back — the company suffered its second consecutive booster failure on a Starship V3 flight. SpaceX confirmed the loss but said the satellites were successfully deployed to target orbit. The failures are worth

watching: reusable boosters are central to SpaceX's economics, and back-to-back losses add friction to an otherwise relentless launch cadence. (TechCrunch)

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## FINANCIAL & MARKETS

*What moved markets, crypto, and the broader economy this week*

**SpaceX Is Quietly Reshaping How Investors Think About Wireless Networks.** A detailed MarketWatch analysis this week argued that SpaceX is not the existential wireless threat that AT&T and Verizon investors fear — at least not yet. Building a standalone cellular network is still prohibitively expensive and slow, and SpaceX would need years of regulatory approvals and infrastructure buildout to compete directly with major carriers. The more likely near-term model is a partnership: SpaceX as a backhaul provider, not a direct competitor. Investors in legacy telcos can breathe, for now. (MarketWatch)

**Kevin Warsh Is the Man Nobody Can Read — Including the Fed.** With the Federal Reserve's next rate decision arriving Wednesday, all eyes are on Kevin Warsh — the former Fed governor who has been unusually quiet about his views on inflation and rate policy. Market positioning heading into the week suggests genuine uncertainty: no one knows whether Warsh will push for a cut, a hold, or something more hawkish. Warsh has long argued that the Fed should be more transparent about its decision-making framework, but his own communication style is anything but. The uncertainty premium is showing up in volatility indexes. (MarketWatch)

**Galaxy Digital's Clarity Act Odds Are Now 30% — and That's What Wall Street Is Watching.** Galaxy Digital cut its odds on the Clarity Act passing to 30% this week, calling it a "last-ditch effort" scenario. Seven Democratic negotiators are pushing for stronger ethics and consumer protections in the latest draft. The bill's fate matters enormously to the stablecoin industry: passage would create a federal framework for dollar-denominated digital assets, removing the patchwork of state-by-state regulations that has slowed institutional adoption. Galaxy's odds cut reflects how Washington works — a bill nobody loves tends to die quietly rather than dramatically. (The Block)

**Wise Is Coming Back for a National Trust Bank Charter — This Time Under GENIUS Act.** The payments company Wise, known for its international money transfers, is planning to resubmit its application for a national trust bank charter under the GENIUS Act framework. The OCC has granted conditional approval to several stablecoin-focused entities since December, and Wise wants in. Getting a federal charter would let Wise offer FDIC-insured accounts and expand its product suite significantly — a meaningful competitive moat against both traditional banks and fintech challengers. (The Block)

**World Foundation Sold \$52.5 Million of WLD Tokens — With a One-Year Lockup.** The World Foundation, which backs the Worldcoin biometric identity project, closed a \$52.5 million token sale in WLD this week. The round was led by Pantera Capital and included Bain Capital Crypto and other institutional names. Critically, the tokens come with a one-year lockup — meaning these investors can't sell for twelve months. That's a signal of conviction: they're betting the project will be worth significantly more after a year of execution than it is today. Whether that bet pays off depends heavily on whether Worldcoin can expand its iris-scanning identity system past early adopter circles. (The Block)

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## BRIEFLY

◀ **Palantir and Anduril Join State Department's Freedom Tech Program** alongside the Bitcoin Policy Institute — a sign that blockchain and defense tech are increasingly overlapping in Washington. (The Block)

◀ **Volkswagen Engineers Charged With Insider Trading Tied to Rivian Joint Venture** — the indictment alleges confidential information about the JVs financial terms was used to buy Rivian shares ahead of public announcements. (TechCrunch)

◀ **Waymo and Uber's Contract Runs Through May 2028** — but Waymo is reportedly exploring a breakup, which would open the door to Waymo distributing its robotaxi service through its own app instead of Uber's platform. (TechCrunch)

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## THE TAKEAWAY

The dominant theme of this Saturday is the quiet maturation of multiple AI narratives at once. OpenAI's keypad is a hardware bet that coding assistance is the killer app — while Prentis is making the opposite wager, that automating mundane digital work matters more than writing code. These aren't contradictory; they're two faces of the same agentic future the industry is racing toward.

In markets, the real signal isn't SpaceX's booster failure or even Kevin Warsh's inscrutability at the Fed — it's the GENIUS Act's slow grind toward passage and Wise's strategic repositioning around a federal bank charter. Stablecoins are being quietly absorbed into the regulatory mainstream, which is exactly the kind of boring, legal, enormous development that precedes a market explosion. Pay attention to the things that feel like paperwork. That's where the money gets made.

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